

# The BUILD Act: Pro-Climate Housing in Action

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## Overview

Illinois is facing a serious housing shortage that is making housing more expensive for working and middle class families. Illinois is already short **142,000 homes and needs to build over 225,000 homes by 2030**. This is fueling an affordability crisis. It is also leading to increased pollution. By embracing the pro-climate zoning and land use reform policies in the BUILD Act, Illinois policymakers can make strides towards addressing both problems at once.

Read More:



### In House District 70



**38%**

of income spent  
on housing



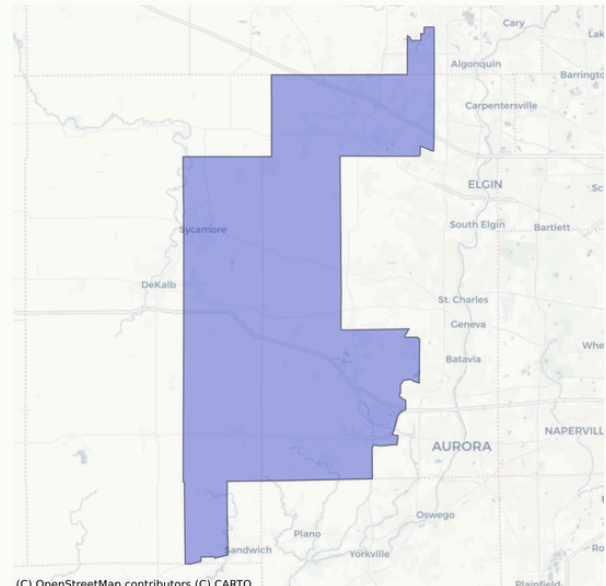
**30%**

avg. increase in  
home value,  
2020-2024



**31%**

avg. increase in  
rent, 2020-2024



## The BUILD Act contains the following key housing policies that will lower families' bills and reduce pollution:

- Eliminating parking minimums
- Legalizing “middle housing” and related zoning reforms
- Building code reform
- Modernizing permitting
- Facilitating Accessory Dwelling Units (ADUs)
- Cutting red tape for rooftop solar and other clean energy retrofits

Sources: US Census Bureau ACS 5-Year 2020 and 2024; Housing and Transportation (H+T<sup>®</sup>) Affordability Index

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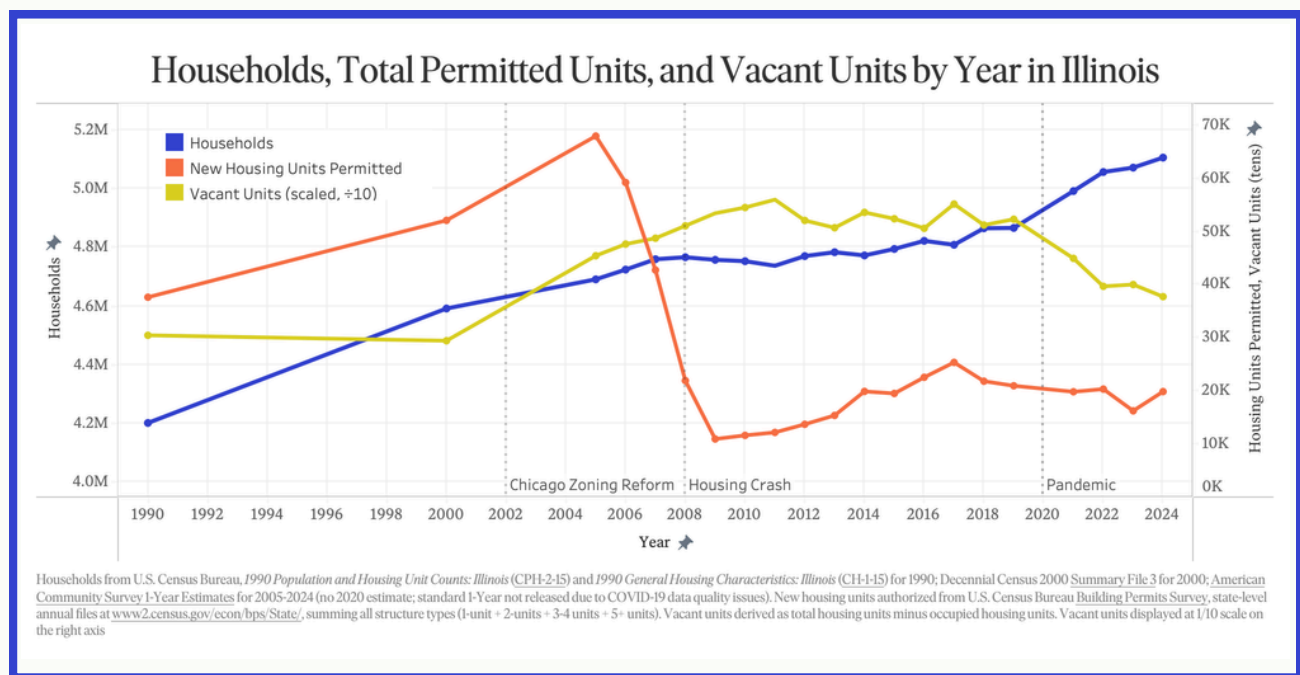
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## Illinois has a chance to showcase true leadership in building pro-climate housing.

Thanks to passing the Northeastern Illinois Transit Authority Act, our state is in a uniquely strong position to reduce pollution by building more housing in walkable, bikeable, and transit-served communities.

**In addition to the climate benefits, building more housing has been shown to reduce costs on first-time buyers and renters.** Pro-climate zoning reforms are not a panacea – other measures to promote stabilization and investments in affordable housing are also important. But studies have shown that these [types of policies](#) can go a long way towards **reducing pollution, tackling climate change, and lowering bills all at the same time.**



*Illinois is not building enough housing to keep up with demand. New housing construction collapsed starting in the early 2000s due to a combination of municipalities adopting restrictive zoning codes, economic crises, and then later the pandemic. Now, Illinois has too few housing units for all the families who want to live here.*

Right now, Illinois policymakers are facing two choices. Continuing with the status quo means that housing costs and pollution will both keep rising. Embracing pro-climate zoning will allow our state to become a leader addressing both at once.

Link: <https://climatecabineteducation.org/housing-policy-that-solves-climate-change/>